

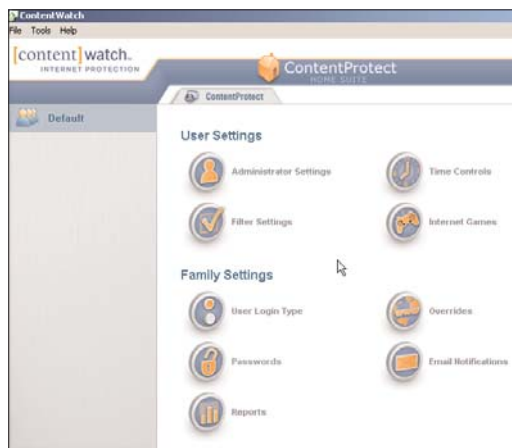
ContentProtect

This is the most expensive of all the software I tested, and will set you back by \$39.99 (Rs 1,800). The first thing I found was that it took me a while to track down the download on www.contentwatch.com, and I was given a serial key even for the trial version. At 5.15 MB, this was another decently-sized download.

Installation and configuration took just 45 seconds. This was the first software I came across that had two passwords—one to uninstall it and one to override the settings. I then found that you could force users to log in to connect to the Net—a very good thing!

This software has additional features such as e-mail notification and the option to disable IMs and chatting tools. One terrible thing is that it doesn't disable the Task Manager, so closing down the application without the administrator password is literally child's play!

ContentProtect did an excellent job of blocking sites, and even stopped me from navigating any further from my innocuous test sites. Google images seemed to be blocked on the basis of the ALT text or filename rather than the image itself, which resulted in quite a bit of flesh peeping through my Web page.



ContentProtect is a good blocker, but without any Task Manager disabling feature, bypassing it is a little too easy for my liking! It blocked some innocuous URLs based on the content

The software logs IM chats though, which is good for the paranoid parent. Here again, "Time Control" was a feature, and lets a user decide how much time on what day of the week his kids should be allowed to use the Net.

Overall, ContentProtect loses badly because it has no way of stopping a kid with basic Windows knowledge from *End Tasking* it! For really little kids, however, this is a decent investment to consider.



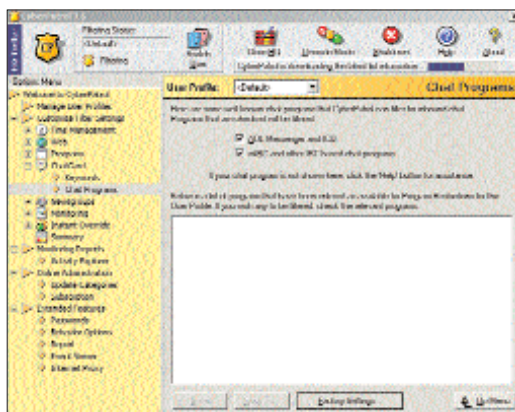
Cyber Patrol

Cyber Patrol (www.cyberpatrol.com) is quite a big download at 12 MB. At \$39.95 (Rs 1,800), it's not exactly the cheapest solution to figure in this test. Add to that the fact that this is a recurring annual subscription cost, and you have one of the most expensive content filters out there.

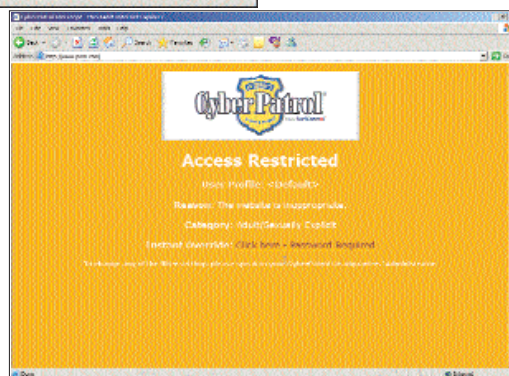
Installation and configuration was easy, and one good thing about the installer is that

you configure as you install. While setting it up, I got an option to select whether I was a home or office user, and to select the age demographic of the users of the computer. I chose "young teen" and then went through the installation.

I had to reboot to finish the setup. I use Opera as my default



Cyber Patrol is not exactly secure, and the bugs I faced when using it soured my opinion of it



browser, and immediately browsed to a very obvious porn site. To my surprise, it just opened up! I then tried Firefox and IE, and the same thing happened. This program just refused to work. I then uninstalled it, re-installed it, rebooted again, and this time it got it right.

It blocked every obvious adult site easily, bringing up a default page. It could not block the Innocuous Sites I threw at it.

Without a Task Manager blocker, this program is easy to bypass for anyone who knows a little about Windows XP. I found three processes, each easily identifiable by their names, and ended them. What shocked me was that when I tried to restart the program, it just brought up an error, telling me to reboot in order to get it working again. I persisted, and on the third attempt to launch the program, it started up again!

Overall, this is a decent software, and blocks dirty stuff pretty well, but there's nothing special about the way it blocks it. The bugs in the way it works are unforgivable. Being one of the most expensive, it certainly didn't live up to my expectations. Personally, I would never spend \$40 a year on this software!